

vaivae.com

Website Brief

Owned domains :

1 vaivae.com

2 vaivae.com

Website Reference: <https://www.situationist.online>

Project summary

Build a luxury editorial e-commerce site for vaivae that communicates refined, quiet authority while functioning as a high-conversion storefront and brand magazine. Use Situationist.online as the UX/visual inspiration: immersive editorial storytelling, minimalist layout, cinematic imagery, strong typographic hierarchy, and focused product discovery.

Objectives

- Present vaivae as an editorial luxury house with emotional brand storytelling.
- Showcase seasonal capsules and hero pieces with magazine-style storytelling.
- Drive direct-to-consumer sales with a refined, frictionless e-commerce experience.
- Build an owned content channel (lookbooks, editorials, brand essays) to create emotional attachment and SEO value.
- Support wholesale & press inquiries and talent/collaboration showcases.

Primary audiences

- Core customer: 25–45, style-conscious, values craftsmanship and editorial design.
- Press & buyers: editors, boutique buyers seeking brand materials.
- VIPs & wholesale partners: concierge service & B2B relationship management.

Key success metrics

- Conversion rate (e-commerce) and average order value
- Time on page for editorial content, bounce rate reduction
- Email capture rate and growth of CRM lists
- Revenue from new launches / capsules
- Press/wholesale inquiries and relationship activations

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Tone & visual direction (reference: Situationist)

- Minimal, editorial, cinematic, confident.
- Full-bleed hero photography, bold typographic statements, generous negative space.
- Limited palette: deep neutrals (charcoal, warm black, ecru, warm ivory) with one seasonal accent. High-contrast photography with moody lighting.
- Typography: elegant serif for headlines + modern sans for nav/UI; large display type for storytelling blocks.
- Micro-interactions: subtle hover reveals, smooth scroll transitions, immersive overlays for lookbook content.

Site architecture (recommended sitemap)

1. Home

- Full-bleed hero (campaign / current capsule)
- Shop highlights (hero product, curated edits)
- Editorial excerpt (latest campaign/lookbook)
- Brand promise / About
- Log in (wishlist, purchase tracking, purchase history)

2. Shop (collection architecture)

- Ready-to-wear (seasonal capsule))
- Editorial / Capsule (limited drops)

3. Product detail page (PDP)

- Large photography / cinematic gallery (zoom + 360 optional)
- Product copy & story-led product description
- Key specs (materials, fit, care)
- Size & fit guidance + model specs
- Stock levels, preorder/limited-run flagging
- Price, variants,
- add-to-cart
- Social share + save to wishlist

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4. Editorial / Journal

- Campaign lookbooks (visual-first)
- Brand essays / founder notes
- Styling edits, behind-the-scenes
- Sort by capsule/season/tag

5. About

- Short brand story (use core line), founder note, brand values, craft & production highlights
- Press

6. Services

- Wholesale & press contact forms

7. Customer Service

- Shipping, returns, sizing guide, FAQs
- Contact form + chat (concierge)
- Account / Wishlist / Gift Cards

8. Footer

- Newsletter signup, social links, legal, privacy, returns, press & wholesale CTA

Core pages content priorities

- Home: strong campaign-led storytelling + clear pathway to shop and editorial.
- PDP- Product Detail Page : photography-first, descriptions, (materials, limited stock), add to cart.
- Editorial: long-form, visual-first pages optimized for social sharing and SEO.
- About: succinct brand manifesto, craft and sourcing signals, founder voice.
- Services & Contact: concierge feel and accessible white-glove touch points.

UX & interaction guidelines

- Immersive hero experiences (click-through to capsule lookbooks).
- Smooth transitions and tasteful animations; avoid excessive motion.
- Quick add-to-cart from collections and PDP with mini cart drawer.
- Persistent header with condensed nav, search, account, cart.
- Product filtering by capsule, fabric, silhouette, color, size, limited edition.
- Wishlist + save for later, gated previews for VIPs.
- Accessible, keyboard-navigable product galleries and forms.

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E-commerce & platform recommendations

- Platform: Shopify Plus (preferred for speed to market, editorial flexibility) OR custom headless (Contentful/Shopify, Sanity/Shopify) if editorial complexity and bespoke interactions require it.
- CMS: support long-form editorial (headless CMS like Sanity or Contentful recommended if decoupling content from shop).
- Payments: Stripe + Apple Pay / Google Pay / Shop Pay.
- Integrations: Klaviyo (email/CRM), Gorgias or Zendesk (support), Recharge (subscriptions if applicable), Yotpo/Stamped (reviews), Instagram/Facebook shop, Google Merchant, ShipStation or equivalent.
- CDN & performance: Cloudflare or built-in CDN, image optimization (WebP), responsive srcset, lazy loading.

SEO & content strategy

- Editorial-first SEO: long-form content optimized around brand, capsule, styling, and product-specific keywords.
- Structured data: product schema, breadcrumb, article schema for editorials.
- URL structure: /shop/, /shop/{collection}/{product-slug}, /journal/{campaign}/{slug}.
- Canonical tags, fast load times, mobile-first indexing.
- Metadata templates for product pages populated from CMS.

Analytics & tracking

- Google Analytics 4 + enhanced e-commerce
- Tag manager (GTM)
- Klaviyo event tracking, conversion funnels, LTV cohorts
- Heatmaps (Hotjar or FullStory) during launch and post-launch optimization

Accessibility & performance

- WCAG AA compliance target
- High contrast for text, keyboard navigation, alt tags for images
- Page speed target: Lighthouse score 90+ on desktop, 70+ on mobile
- Image-heavy pages should use progressive loading and critical CSS



Security & legal

- SSL mandatory
- GDPR/COPPA/CCPA compliance where applicable
- Cookie banner with consent management
- Terms, privacy policy, return policy pages

Content & creative deliverables (from client)

- Hero campaign imagery (high-res, multiple crops & video if available)
- Product photography: 3-6 angles per product + 1–2 editorial lifestyle images + 1 video
- Editorial lookbook imagery & captions
- Product copy: story-led descriptions + technical specs
- Brand assets: logo (SVG), typography files, color palette, packaging photography
- Size charts, material & production notes, certifications (if any)
- Founder bio + brand manifesto copy

Technical deliverables (from agency/dev)

- Functional prototype (Figma/WA)
- High-fidelity designs for desktop, tablet, mobile
- Headless CMS templates for editorial and product pages
- Fully integrated e-commerce build, QA across devices/browsers
- Performance optimization & accessibility audit
- Deployment plan & staging environment
- Staff training doc for CMS & order management

Launch timeline (example, adjustable)

- Week 0: Discovery & brand audit, content & asset collection
- Week 1: IA, wireframes, UX signoff
- Week 2-3: Visual design (desktop + responsive)
- Week 3-4: Development (shop setup, CMS, integrations)
- Week 5: QA, accessibility audit, performance tuning
- Week 7: Soft launch (internal), live launch + marketing activation
- Post-launch: 4 weeks monitoring & iterative improvements



Premium features

- Members-only capsule access / gated commerce
- Package tracking portal
- Personalized homepage experiences for returning customers
- Multi-currency / localized storefronts